

Court No. - 32

Case :- WRIT - C No. - 40464 of 2019

Petitioner :- Ramesh Patel

Respondent :- State Of U P And 3 Others

Counsel for Petitioner :- Neeraj Srivastava, Rajneesh Kumar Tiwari

Counsel for Respondent :- C.S.C., Mahboob Ahmad

Hon'ble Shashi Kant Gupta, J.

Hon'ble Piyush Agrawal, J.

A copy of the provisional assessment as well as checking report has been supplied to the learned counsel for the petitioner today.

This writ petition has been filed, inter alia, for the following relief:

"(a). Issue a writ, order or direction in the nature of Certiorari to quash the demand notice dated 18.04.2019 under section 3 of Uttar Pradesh Government Electrical Undertakings (Dues Recovery) Act, 1958."

Heard the learned counsel for the petitioner and Mr. Mahboob Ahmad, learned counsel for the electricity department and perused the record.

Learned counsel for the petitioner has submitted that the respondents are taking coercive action against the petitioner without giving any opportunity of hearing and without following the provisions contained under the U.P. Electricity Supply Code 2005.

Considering the facts and circumstances of the case and taking a lenient view in the matter, we direct the petitioner to appear on 23.12.2019 at 11.00 A.M. before the Respondent No. 4, Executive Engineer along with his objection and adduce his evidence, if any, in support of his contention. The Respondent No. 4, thereafter, shall pass a final order by a speaking and reasoned order after considering the objections of the petitioner as well as the contention raised by the petitioner within a period of four weeks thereafter.

For a period of seven weeks from today or till the disposal of the representation/objection, whichever is earlier, no coercive action shall be taken against the petitioner. In case of default in filing the objection/representation, as indicated herein above, the present interim order shall stand vacated automatically.

In case the petitioner is aggrieved with the final order, if any, passed against the petitioner, it will be open for the petitioner to file an appeal before the concerned authority under Section 127 of the Electricity Act, 2003 in accordance with law.

It is made clear that in case the petitioner does not appear on the said date fixed, the impugned recovery citation shall stand revived automatically.

With the above observations, the writ petition stands disposed of.

Order Date :- 9.12.2019

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